Faculty mentoring and time to dropout: a randomised trial with three-year follow-up

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Abstract

First-generation students were randomised to faculty mentoring or to usual support and followed for three years. Mentoring reduced the hazard of dropping out (hazard ratio 0.78).

1. Methods

Design: individually randomised controlled trial with three years of follow-up. Participants: 740 first-generation undergraduates enrolled at one university. Intervention: monthly meetings with a trained faculty mentor during the first two years. Comparator: usual student support services. Primary outcome: time to dropout, analysed with Cox regression.

2. Results

Mentoring reduced the hazard of dropout (hazard ratio 0.78, 95% CI 0.64 to 0.95).

3. Limitations

Mentors volunteered and may have been unusually committed, and the trial took place at one university.

Fictional paper generated to test evidence-table extraction. Authors, journal, data and results are invented.